

*The body deserves
to be understood.*

JOUISSANCE • AUGUST 2026



COME UNDONE

A THIRTEEN-DAY COMPANION

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A THIRTEEN-DAY COMPANION

*Read slowly.
One day at a time.*

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*Read these pages
the way you would
want to be read.*

I wrote these pages because I believe most people arrive at intimate experiences without a map.

Not a map of how to perform. Not instructions. A map of what is actually happening, physiologically and neurologically, during the sequence of arousal and opening. A map of why the things I do work, so that you are not simply following a lead but understanding where you are in the territory.

These thirteen pages are not theory. They are things I have learned from my intimate exchanges with people over years, combined with the research that confirmed what I was already observing. I wanted to give you both layers: what I believe from experience, and what the science says is happening underneath.

Each page corresponds to one day of the thirteen days leading up to August 14th. You don't have to read them in order. You don't have to agree with all of it. What I would ask is that you read them with your body, not just your head. Notice what lands and what doesn't. Notice what creates a reaction in you. That reaction is information.

What this handbook is not: a set of instructions for how to respond. There is no correct response. There is no performance you need to produce. There is no experience you should be having that you're not having. These pages exist to reduce the gap between what your body is capable of and what you've been given access to. The capability was always there. What varies is the environment, the sequence, and the presence of someone who knows what they're doing.

What happens on August 14th is between you and your body. I'll be there to create the conditions. The opening is yours.

I have done this work because I find it the most honest thing I can offer: not expertise performed at a distance, but careful attention to what is actually happening in a human body when it is given the right conditions. Most people have never been given those conditions. I think that matters.

Read these pages the way you would want to be read. Carefully. With attention to the places that make you uncomfortable. Those are usually the places that are most true.

See you on the 14th.

P

*Your body is not a machine to be optimised.
It is a landscape
to be explored.*

78% of nervous system signals travel
body-to-brain, not brain-to-body

Why most people have never actually received pleasure

THE IDEA

Most people have never actually received pleasure. They have performed it.

I believe that most people have never actually received pleasure. Not fully. Not in the way that changes you afterward. They've experienced sensation. They've felt arousal. They've had orgasms. But receiving, really receiving, is something most people have never practiced.

This is not a judgment. It's a structural problem. When you're doing something, your mind has a job. It moves, initiates, calibrates, adjusts. When someone is doing something to you, the mind has nothing to do except watch. And watching is exactly the problem.

Receiving is a skill. It requires safety, attention, and the willingness to stop performing.

You have been trained, through years of competence and self-management, to be in control of most things that happen to you. In professional settings. In social settings. In intimate ones. The monitoring mind that makes you good at most things is the same one that prevents full receiving. It doesn't switch off because the situation is intimate. It adapts. It performs openness instead of being open.

WHAT YOUR BODY IS DOING

The ability to receive pleasure is regulated by the nervous system's threat-assessment functions. When a person is in control of a situation, the prefrontal cortex (executive function, planning, self-monitoring) stays active. This is useful for most tasks. In intimate receiving contexts, this same monitoring activity competes with the parasympathetic nervous system response required for full arousal and sensation.

Research on sexual response shows that inhibitory circuits, those that produce self-monitoring and performance anxiety, directly suppress arousal pathways (Bancroft and Janssen, 2000). The experience of giving pleasure keeps these circuits usefully occupied. The experience of receiving, with nothing to do, leaves

TODAY'S PRACTICE

- 1 Notice one sensation in your body right now. Name it without judgement.
- 2 Place a hand on your chest and feel it move.
- 3 That is arrival. That is the whole practice.

Permission

*Permission is not something
you wait to receive.
It is something you practice giving.*

THE THREE STEPS

1 Notice the impulse

2 Choose deliberately

3 Give it openly

3 steps
notice the impulse
choose deliberately
give it openly

The performance trap

THE IDEA

Permission is not passive. It is an active choice made in the body, not the mind.

I think the performance trap is the most honest thing I can name at the start of this. Because if you're reading this, there's a good chance you already know it from the inside.

It goes like this: you're present, aroused, the moment is real. And somewhere in the body, a second layer activates. You start watching yourself. Not because something went wrong. Because the monitoring mind rose up to manage the experience, to calibrate the signal you're sending, to make sure what you're communicating matches what you think you should feel.

You do not need to believe it yet. You only need to practice saying it.

You have been trained to perform. Not by anyone malicious. By every situation in your life that required you to manage the impression you made. That training doesn't distinguish between professional contexts and intimate ones. It runs everywhere. What you've learned to do in professional stressful meetings and awkward social situations, your body does in bed.

WHAT YOUR BODY IS DOING

Sexual self-monitoring, sometimes called "spectatoring," was identified by Masters and Johnson as a primary inhibitor of arousal and orgasm. When a person observes themselves during a sexual encounter rather than fully experiencing it, activity in the self-referential neural network (the default mode network) remains elevated. This competes with sensory processing circuits.

Neuroimaging studies of orgasm show that regions associated with self-monitoring and fear must deactivate for full orgasmic response to occur (Komisaruk and Whipple, 2005). This deactivation cannot be voluntarily produced. It is induced by sufficient sensory saturation, parasympathetic dominance, and felt safety. The route through spectatoring is not willpower. It is overwhelm of the monitoring system by direct experience.

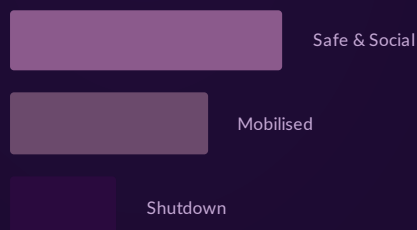
TODAY'S PRACTICE

- 1 Say aloud: 'I give myself permission to feel this.'
- 2 Notice what shifts when you say it. You do not need to believe it yet.
- 3 Say it again. That is the practice.

The Nervous System

*The nervous system is not
the enemy of pleasure.
It is the map.*

THE VAGAL LADDER



Each state has its own path upward.

5 states

on the vagal ladder,
each with its own physiology

What your body already knows

THE IDEA

The nervous system regulates your capacity for pleasure before anything else happens.

Your nervous system doesn't wait for you to decide you feel safe. It decides for you, about three hundred milliseconds before you've formed a thought about it.

I find this remarkable. It means the body is always ahead of the story. By the time you've told yourself "I feel comfortable here," your nervous system made that call three hundred milliseconds ago and is already acting on it. It's also true in reverse: by the time you've told yourself "this is fine," your nervous system may have already registered that something is off and quietly started holding.

The ladder moves up one rung at a time. Breath is how you climb.

Your body reads specific things. Not the story you're telling yourself about the situation. Not your history with this person or how long you've known them. It reads the quality of a voice. The predictability of touch. The presence in a room. Whether the breath of the person near you is held or moving.

WHAT YOUR BODY IS DOING

The polyvagal theory (Porges, 2011) describes how the autonomic nervous system continuously monitors the environment for safety cues through a process called neuroception, occurring below conscious awareness. This system evaluates voice prosody, facial expression, movement quality, and touch predictability, and routes the result directly to physiological response before conscious processing occurs.

When neuroception detects safety, the ventral vagal complex activates: this produces the subjective experience of ease, openness, and connection. The dorsal vagal branch produces shutdown and dissociation. The sympathetic branch produces fight-or-flight activation. All three affect sexual response directly. Only ventral vagal activation is compatible with full arousal and sensation. This state cannot be created by intention alone.

This is created by environmental cues.

TODAY'S PRACTICE

- 1 Stand tall. Feel your feet on the floor.
- 2 Take three breaths, exhale longer than the inhale.
- 3 The ladder moves up. You just moved.

*Breath is the one autonomic function you can choose.
That is not a small thing.*

4 : 4

in for four, out for four,
the simplest reset your system knows

Breath is not technique. It is permission.

THE IDEA

Every breath is a negotiation between your body and its safety signal.

I want to say this plainly because it's one of the things I come back to most: breath is not technique. It is not something you do correctly or incorrectly. It is the switch between bracing and receiving, between sensation that arrives and sensation that gets caught at the door.

Your breath is the most direct access point your body has to its own nervous system state. When you exhale fully and let your belly soften on the exhale, your heart rate drops slightly and your vagus nerve activates the parasympathetic system. That is the branch responsible for rest, connection, and sexual response. It cannot run at the same time as vigilance.

Every exhale is a small act of trust. You let go. The body delivers.

Most people, as arousal increases, unconsciously hold their breath. It is not a choice. It is what the body does when sensation gets intense enough to feel uncertain. The held breath creates a micro-contraction throughout the pelvic floor, which compresses the very structures that need to open. This is the mechanical catch. The closer you get to something real, the more likely your body is to brace against it. The bracing cuts off circulation to the structures that produce the sensation. The sensation diminishes. You think you lost it. You didn't. You held your breath.

WHAT YOUR BODY IS DOING

Controlled breathing studies confirm that extended exhalation activates the parasympathetic nervous system via vagal stimulation, reducing heart rate and cortisol, and shifting the autonomic balance toward rest-and-digest (Jerath et al., 2006). During arousal, involuntary breath-holding is a sympathetic stress response: the diaphragm tenses, intra-abdominal pressure increases, and pelvic floor musculature contracts reflexively. This is physiologically incompatible with vasocongestion and the engorgement process that deepens arousal. Sound during exhalation serves a secondary mechanical function: it forces the glottis open, preventing re-closure, and

TODAY'S PRACTICE

- 1 Inhale for 4 counts. Exhale for 4 counts. Three times.
- 2 After the third exhale, pause. Notice the space.
- 3 That space is your nervous system resetting. Stay there.

The Excitation-Inhibition Balance

*Your accelerator and brake
are both running,
all the time.*

BOTH ALWAYS RUNNING

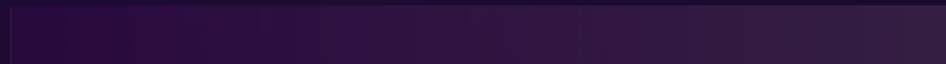
ACCELERATOR

excitatory



BRAKE

inhibitory



The question is never on or off. Only the ratio.

2

systems always running:
one gas pedal, one brake

The thing you have never asked for out loud

THE IDEA

Arousal is not just the accelerator. Your brake is always on. Both systems matter.

I want to start here with something I've observed: most people have a clear sense of what they want in intimate moments. They know it. They feel it. And they say nothing.

The fear is that saying it will break it. That naming what you want makes it cognitive, pulls you out of your body and into your head, turns the moment into a negotiation. You've probably had experiences where you said something and the atmosphere shifted. The magic leaked out of the room. And you filed that away as evidence that asking is costly.

More arousal is not the goal. A clearer signal is.

Here is a different reading of that moment.

WHAT YOUR BODY IS DOING

Verbal communication during intimacy activates different neural pathways depending on the mode of communication. Indirect signaling, hinting through movement or sound, requires sustained executive function to calibrate the signal. This keeps the prefrontal cortex partially engaged, which competes with the deactivation of self-monitoring required for deep arousal.

Direct, body-sourced language ("there," "slower," "more") is processed differently: it is brief enough that it does not interrupt sensory processing, and it eliminates the secondary cognitive load of managing the implicit signal. Research on sexual communication shows that direct verbal feedback is associated with significantly higher partner satisfaction and orgasm frequency compared to indirect signaling (Lavner et al., 2016). The mechanism is not social: it is neurological. Less cognitive overhead, more sensation.

TODAY'S PRACTICE

- 1 Acknowledge your brake: what is making you cautious today?
- 2 Acknowledge your accelerator: what draws you forward?
- 3 You need not turn either off. Notice the ratio between them.

Frustration as Information

Frustration is not the absence of desire.

It is desire

with nowhere to go yet.

THE SIGNAL CHAIN

Desire

Frustration

Information

100% offrustration contains
information about what you want

Why I slow down instead of speeding up

THE IDEA

Frustration is the body saying: desire is present, pathway is blocked. Read it.

The pause before contact is not decoration. It is a technique, and I use it deliberately.

When your body knows touch is coming but doesn't know exactly when, something happens to your nervous system: it orients toward the source. The attention narrows. The breath changes. Sensation is heightened even before anything physical occurs because the body is already moving toward the thing it is waiting for.

Frustration is a compass. It always points toward what you want.

Most sexual encounters rush past this phase entirely. Contact follows desire follows context, quickly, with very little space between. That works for a certain kind of experience. For the experience we are building toward, it is a problem. The door hasn't finished opening before someone tries to walk through it.

WHAT YOUR BODY IS DOING

Anticipation activates the dopaminergic reward pathway before contact occurs. The nucleus accumbens and ventral tegmental area respond to expected reward, not just delivered reward, creating a neurochemical arousal state that precedes and amplifies physical sensation (Schultz, 2015). In sexual contexts, this is why prolonged anticipation increases both subjective arousal and genital vasocongestion: blood flow to pelvic structures increases during the anticipation phase, producing engorgement before any direct touch.

The subjective frustration of delayed gratification during arousal is a reliable indicator of elevated dopamine tone. The nervous system is primed. Touch that arrives into a fully primed nervous system produces qualitatively different sensation than touch that arrives into a neutral state.

TODAY'S PRACTICE

- 1 Name the frustration without solving it.
- 2 Ask: what does this frustration point toward that I want?
- 3 Let the answer be simple. Frustration is a compass.

*Wanting is allowed to exist
without immediately
becoming doing.*

3 layers

what the body wants
what the mind wants
what the self wants

Wanting without chasing

THE IDEA

You are allowed to want things you cannot name. Wanting is complete without resolution.

Most people treat arousal like a switch. You're turned on or you're not. You feel it or you don't. What I've learned, working closely with the body over years, is that this framing misses the whole thing.

Arousal is a sequence. It builds in stages that have specific physiological signatures. When you skip stages, you run into problems that feel psychological but are actually structural. And the biggest mistake people make is treating the beginning of arousal as permission to proceed toward the middle.

The body knows what it wants before the mind has language for it.

Stage one is preparation. Blood flow begins. The labia start to engorge. The vaginal walls start producing lubrication. This is the body getting ready. Most people interpret the beginning of this phase as being turned on and treat it as a signal to move faster. That is too fast.

WHAT YOUR BODY IS DOING

The sexual response cycle described by Masters and Johnson (1966) identified distinct physiological stages: excitement, plateau, orgasm, resolution. Research by Rosemary Basson (2001) revised this model significantly for many women: rather than spontaneous desire initiating arousal, responsiveness to contextual stimuli initiates arousal, with subjective desire emerging in response to early physiological changes. This is called the responsive desire model.

Practically, this means the question "am I turned on?" is less useful than "is my body responding?" Engorgement of vestibular bulbs and vaginal lubrication can occur before conscious desire is felt. Waiting for felt desire before proceeding may mean skipping the early arousal stages that make later stages accessible. The sequence, followed in order, produces experiences that skipping produces doesn't.

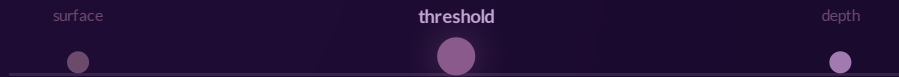
TODAY'S PRACTICE

- 1 Let yourself want something today without acting on it immediately.
- 2 Notice where the wanting lives in your body.
- 3 Wanting is information. Your only job is to receive it.

Sensation

*Sensation is not a fixed quantity.
It changes with attention,
safety, and time.*

WHERE SENSATION LIVES



Attention moves the dot. Not effort.

9-11 cm

average depth, sensation lives at
the threshold, not the destination

The difference between sensation and experience

THE IDEA

Sensation is not where you think it is. Attention changes what the body can feel.

The anatomy you learned was incomplete.

Not wrong exactly. A fragment. The diagram you saw in school showed the external genitalia as separate structures: the labia, the clitoris as a small external nub, the vaginal opening. What it didn't show was that the clitoris is mostly internal.

Attention is not passive. Where you place it, the body follows.

The full clitoral complex extends 9 to 11 centimeters inside the body. What you can see and touch externally is the tip of a much larger wishbone-shaped structure. From the glans, the body runs upward and divides into two crura, long arms that extend back along the pelvic arch. Flanking the vaginal opening on each side are the vestibular bulbs, internal erectile tissue that engorges with arousal and wraps the vaginal canal.

WHAT YOUR BODY IS DOING

Research by O'Connell et al. (1998) revised the anatomical model of the clitoris using detailed dissection: the full structure is substantially larger than depicted in standard medical diagrams, comprising an external glans and body, paired internal crura along the pelvic arch, and vestibular bulbs flanking the vaginal canal. During arousal, all components undergo vasocongestion.

Foldes and Buisson (2009), using dynamic ultrasound imaging during arousal, confirmed that the vestibular bulbs engorge and compress the vaginal canal, and the G-spot region (anterior vaginal wall overlying the internal clitoral body) becomes palpable and pressure-sensitive only at sufficient arousal. Orgasm type corresponds to which structures are engaged. The sequence of arousal determines which structures activate. Skipping early stages means later stages are anatomically inaccessible, not psychologically resistant.

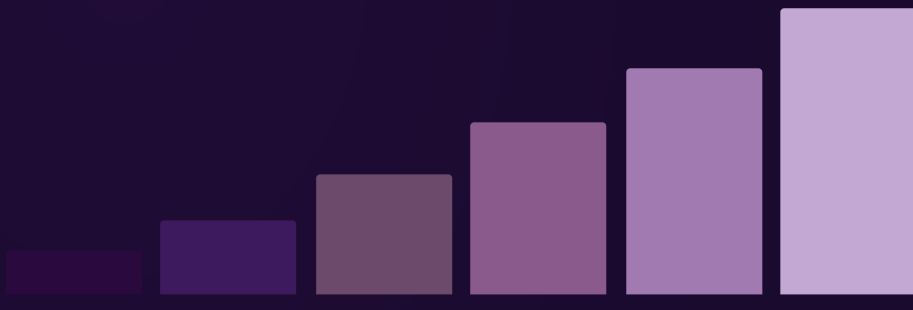
TODAY'S PRACTICE

- 1 Choose one area of your body. Place your full attention there.
- 2 Stay for 60 seconds. Let sensation come to you, not the other way.
- 3 This is the practice: attention without agenda.

Sound

*Sound is permission
made audible.*

SOUND AS PERMISSION



One sound changes the entire room.

I sound
is enough to change
the entire room

What I am actually listening for

THE IDEA

Sound is the most direct way the nervous system communicates state to the room.

Silence collapses sensation upward.

I've seen this many times. When someone goes quiet during high arousal, the body has nowhere to route the signal. Sensation starts in the pelvis, moves through the trunk, and if there's no exit, it arrives in the head and becomes thought. Am I doing this right? What am I making him think? How long has it been?

You cannot make a wrong sound. Only an unsent one.

Sound routes sensation downward and outward. This is not metaphor. It is the simple mechanics of what happens when you open your mouth, stop filtering, and let whatever wants to come out actually come out.

WHAT YOUR BODY IS DOING

Vocalization during arousal serves multiple physiological functions. Sound production requires exhalation, which activates the parasympathetic nervous system via vagal stimulation. Open-mouth vocalization prevents the involuntary breath-holding that compresses pelvic musculature. Sound also functions as interoceptive feedback: the body's auditory processing of its own vocalizations serves as a confirmation signal that reinforces ongoing arousal (Brody and Krüger, 2006).

The suppression of sexual vocalization is conditioned through social learning and produces real neurophysiological costs: it sustains sympathetic activation (monitoring, suppression effort) and interrupts the sensory saturation necessary for self-monitoring deactivation. Uninhibited vocalization is not a symptom of arousal. For many people it is a precondition of it.

TODAY'S PRACTICE

- 1 Make one sound today. Louder than comfortable.
- 2 Notice what happens in your chest, your throat, the room.
- 3 Do it once more. Notice the difference.

*Trust is not given once.
It is rebuilt in each small moment
of keeping your word.*



shortcuts to trust.
Only the long road.

The withdrawal

THE IDEA

Trust is a biological process. It rebuilds through small kept promises, not declarations.

You can trust someone cognitively and still be closed.

I mean that structurally, not emotionally. You can have read everything. You can believe the methodology is sound. You can have chosen to be here freely, enthusiastically, with full informed consent. And your body will still wait to see.

Earned trust is not a feeling. It is a physical change in the nervous system.

The opening isn't built through information. It is built through cues your nervous system collects without asking you. Voice quality. Movement speed. Whether the hands near you move with decision or with hesitation. Whether the person in the room is tracking you or managing a plan. Whether the pace matches your pace or its own.

WHAT YOUR BODY IS DOING

Neuroception, the nervous system's below-conscious threat assessment, operates continuously and updates based on accumulated cues. Initial trust, even genuine conscious trust, does not override this system. The autonomic nervous system requires ongoing sensory evidence: voice consistency, movement predictability, attentive tracking rather than plan-execution.

Research on therapeutic touch and somatic interventions shows that parasympathetic access deepens incrementally across an encounter as the nervous system accumulates safety evidence (Dana, 2018). Physical environment contributes directly: ambient temperature, sound quality, and light level are processed as safety or threat cues by the same limbic structures that process social cues. The opening of deep arousal states is a cumulative physiological process, not a decision made once at the start.

TODAY'S PRACTICE

- 1 Identify one small thing you promised yourself today.
- 2 Keep it. Even if it is tiny. Especially if it is tiny.
- 3 You are building trust with your own nervous system.

Surrender

Surrender is not weakness.

It is the advanced practice.

THE SURRENDER SPECTRUM

MANAGING



SOFTENING

10%

OPENING

and again

Not all at once. Ten percent at a time.

10%

soften your grip
by ten percent.
that is the whole practice

Surrender is not passive. It is the hardest thing.

THE IDEA

The body cannot surrender while the mind is managing the outcome. One must yield.

The first opening is the hardest.

It requires you to believe, in your body rather than just your mind, that you're in a safe enough place to let sensation move freely. That takes evidence. It takes the right environment, the right pace, the right cues from the person you're with.

The mind wants to manage the outcome. The body needs you to stop.

But there is a second layer, and most people don't know it exists.

WHAT YOUR BODY IS DOING

Polyvagal theory describes the nervous system's tendency to reassert protection at each new threshold of vulnerability. This is an adaptive mechanism: the system does not simply open once and stay open. Each increment of deeper experience is assessed as a new situation. The body literally re-evaluates.

The specific physical markers of this re-engagement are well-documented in somatic therapy literature: jaw tension, finger flexion, scapular bracing, and breath shallowing all indicate that protective tone has returned to the musculature. These are involuntary. The practice of releasing them requires body awareness, not willpower. Exhalation with conscious attention to the tension site is the most reliable access: exhaling drops intercostal and diaphragmatic tone, which cascades into pelvic floor release. This is teachable. It is also exactly what "breathe" means in practice.

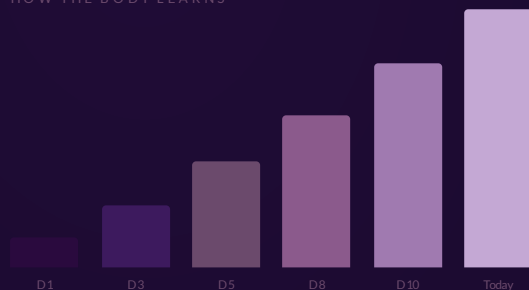
TODAY'S PRACTICE

- 1 Find something you are currently controlling. Just notice it.
- 2 Take one breath and soften your grip by 10%.
- 3 That is the whole practice. Surrender is incremental.

The Body Learns

*The body learns
not through repetition alone
but through presence.*

HOW THE BODY LEARNS



Not repetition. Presence.

21 days
is a myth.
the body learns on
its own schedule

What the body remembers

THE IDEA

Neuroplasticity is not about repetition. It is about presence during the unfamiliar.

After an orgasm, your body doesn't return to baseline immediately. There is a window.

The physiological state immediately after orgasm is still aroused. Vasocongestion hasn't fully resolved. The nervous system is in a specific state: parasympathetic dominance, elevated oxytocin, warmth spreading from the core. The pelvic structures are still engorged. The nervous system is still open.

You are not behind. You are exactly where the body places you.

This is the window. It lasts between two and fifteen minutes depending on the person, the depth of the orgasm, and what happens next.

WHAT YOUR BODY IS DOING

The post-orgasmic refractory period in women is substantially shorter than in men and is not universal. Immediately following orgasm, oxytocin and prolactin are elevated, producing the subjective warmth and bonding experience. Crucially, vasocongestion resolves gradually: pelvic engorgement persists for several minutes, meaning the anatomical structures are still primed (Masters and Johnson, 1966).

If stimulation continues and the nervous system remains in parasympathetic dominance during this window, the threshold for subsequent orgasm is lower. Neuroplasticity research supports that repeated threshold-crossings update the nervous system's model of possibility: the pattern is encoded somatically, and subsequent arousal states show faster progression through the same stages (Doidge, 2007). The body learns what is possible. The ceiling moves.

TODAY'S PRACTICE

- 1 Notice one moment today when something felt different than before.
- 2 That is the learning. You do not need to understand it.
- 3 Show up again tomorrow.

*I won't tell you
not to be frightened.
You may be. I'll be there.*

o effort
required to arrive.
you are already here.

A note before tomorrow

THE IDEA

Monitoring kills arousal. The body cannot be both the performer and the audience.

There is a moment when the body stops asking permission.

Before that moment, you're in it. You're aware of it. You're present and responding and in contact with what's happening. That is real and it is good.

The monitor is the part of you that watches. Today, you stop watching.

After the second threshold, something different happens. The body starts moving on its own. Your hips find a rhythm you didn't choose. Your breath deepens without you deciding to deepen it. Your hands do something or don't do something, and you notice it after. The experience is no longer something you're participating in. It is happening to you, through you, as you.

WHAT YOUR BODY IS DOING

The second threshold corresponds neurologically to a shift from conscious participation to tonic immobility or flow states, in which the default mode network deactivates significantly and proprioceptive feedback dominates. EEG studies during deep sexual response show patterns associated with reduced self-referential processing and heightened sensory integration, similar to states described in meditation research (Komisaruk and Whipple, 2005).

The involuntary motor responses observed at this threshold (pelvic rhythmicity, breath deepening, spontaneous vocalization) are driven by spinal reflex arcs that operate below cortical control. These reflexes are suppressed by sustained cortical monitoring. They activate when monitoring deactivates. The pathway is not through effort. It is through the absence of effort. Through not grabbing the wheel. This is what every previous day has been preparing.

TODAY'S PRACTICE

- 1 You are allowed to arrive exactly as you are.
- 2 Bring the uncertainty. Bring the anticipation. Bring the body you have.
- 3 Nothing is required except presence.

*The body deserves
to be understood.*

CLOSING NOTE

These thirteen pages exist because the body deserves to be understood.

Not managed. Not optimized. Not pushed through a sequence in the dark. Understood.

What happens on August 14th will be shaped by everything you've read here and by everything you bring that has no name. Both matter. The knowledge is not a replacement for the experience. It is the context that makes the experience possible.

I'll see you there.

P